

Regular-entry prose pilot 02

Assembly-only pilot for newly drafted compact regular-entry commentary. The trace rendering is reused, but the prose comes from a separate book-prose layer rather than from the model-entry report sections.

bake — OE bacan

Derivation: **bākanq* > *bacan* (regular).

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
West Germanic		Anglo Frisian Brightening	<i>*bækanq</i>
[no change]		OE A Restoration	<i>*bakanq</i>
Northwest Germanic		OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope	<i>*bakan</i>
[no change]		OE Secondary Nasalization	<i>*bakqn</i>
		OE Weak Tail Reduction	<i>*bakan</i>

Orel's **bakanan* and Campbell's standard examples of A-restoration both point to the ordinary weak verb continued by Old English *bacan* (Orel 2003; Campbell 1959, 61; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 270). The dictionary evidence is uncomplicated: *bacan* is the attested infinitive headword in Old English (Bosworth and Toller 1898, 72; Clark Hall 1960, 19). What matters here is the regular phonology. After Anglo-Frisian brightening, A-restoration before single *k* returns the stem vowel to *a*, and the later weak-verb tail reductions produce the expected infinitive.

beech — OE bōc

Derivation: **bōkō* > *bōc* (regular).

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
West Germanic		OE High Vowel Apocope	<i>*bōk</i>
[no change]			
Northwest Germanic			
NWGmc Final Long O Raising	<i>*bōku</i>		

Kroonen's **bōk(j)ō-* already distinguishes nominative *boc* from oblique *bēce*, so the relevant comparator here is the nominative-singular line represented as *bōc* (Kroonen 2013, 81). With **bōkō* as input, the derivation is as compact as the trace suggests: final long *ō* raises in Northwest Germanic, then high-vowel apocope leaves *bōc*. The prose therefore only needs one reminder: the oblique *bēce* belongs to the same paradigm, but not to the form chosen for direct comparison.

bier — OE bæ̃r

Derivation: **bērō* > *bæ̃r* (regular).

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
West Germanic		OE High Vowel Apocope	<i>*bæ̃r</i>
[no change]			
Northwest Germanic			
NWGmc Final Long O Raising	<i>*béru</i>		
NWGmc Long E Lowering	<i>*bæ̃ru</i>		

Kroonen's **bērō-* and the Old English evidence *bar*, *bæ̃r* point to an uncomplicated feminine noun continued here as normalized *bæ̃r* (Kroonen 2013, 717; Clark Hall 1960, 32; Bosworth and Toller 1898, 73). The only real editorial issue is spelling: the dictionaries transmit *bæ̃r* or *bar*, while the book form *bæ̃r* simply marks the long vowel explicitly. Once that normalization is stated,

the derivation remains regular: final long $\bar{o}$ raises, long $\bar{e}$ lowers to $\bar{æ}$, and apocope yields the expected Old English form.

both — OE $b\bar{u}$

Derivation: $*b\bar{o} > b\bar{u}$ (regular).

Earlier Germanic changes	Old English changes
West Germanic	[no change]
[no change]	
Northwest Germanic	
NWGMc Stressed Monosyllable O Raising $*b\bar{u}$	

The regular item here is not the better-known masculine dual $b\bar{e}gen$ but the inherited neuter dual $b\bar{u}$. Kroonen's paradigm under $*ba-$ includes precisely that unextended $*b\bar{o}$ form alongside the wider dual set, and the Old English grammars likewise preserve neuter $b\bar{u}$ beside masculine $b\bar{e}gen$ and feminine $b\bar{a}$ (Kroonen 2013, 47; Sievers 1965, 324; Campbell 1959, 295; Fulk 2018, 223). That makes $b\bar{u}$ the cleanest regular comparator for this entry: it is attested Old English, and it does not depend on the more debated extended formation behind $b\bar{e}gen$. Campbell and Brunner both treat final stressed $\bar{o} > \bar{u}$ as an ordinary West Germanic-to-Old-English development, with $b\bar{u}$ among the standard examples (Campbell 1959, 122; Sievers 1965, 69).

Comparison note. The historical discussion of $b\bar{e}gen$ and the continental forms behind Modern English *both* belongs to a related but different problem. Orel still cites an older $*b\bar{o}-j-$ explanation, while Fulk reports Seebold's preference for $*b\bar{o}-p-$ (Orel 2003, 45; Fulk 2018, 223). Those formations matter for the wider history of the numeral, but they do not displace the regular comparison $*b\bar{o} > b\bar{u}$ used here.

bow — OE $b\bar{i}e\bar{g}an$

Derivation: $*b\bar{a}ugijan\bar{q} > b\bar{i}e\bar{g}an$ (regular).

Earlier Germanic changes	Old English changes
West Germanic	OE Au Fronting $*b\bar{a}eugijan\bar{q}$
[no change]	OE Diphthong Leveling $*b\bar{e}agijan\bar{q}$
Northwest Germanic	OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope $*b\bar{e}agijan$
[no change]	OE Secondary Nasalization $*b\bar{e}agij\bar{a}n$
	Sievers Law Syncope $*b\bar{e}agj\bar{a}n$
	OE Velar Palatalization $*b\bar{e}a\bar{d}j\bar{a}n$
	OE I Umlaut $*b\bar{i}e\bar{d}j\bar{a}n$
	OE Weak Tail Reduction $*b\bar{i}e\bar{d}j\bar{a}n$
	OE J Loss After Heavy $*b\bar{i}e\bar{d}j\bar{a}n$

Kroonen's weak causative $*baugjan-$ and Ringe and Taylor's fuller chain to West Saxon *biegan* place this verb firmly within the ordinary bend-family rather than among analogical repair cases (Kroonen 2013, 75; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 94). Old English dictionary evidence is straightforward, and the spelling $b\bar{i}e\bar{g}an$ here is simply a normalized representation of the attested weak verb (Clark Hall 1960, 34; Bosworth and Toller 1898, 102). The regularity lies in the sequence after pre-Old-English $*b\bar{e}agjan$: palatalization of gj and i-mutation produce the West Saxon infinitive, so the prose only needs to identify the causative lexeme and confirm that the output belongs to the expected verbal line.

fare — OE $faran$

Derivation: $*f\bar{a}ran\bar{q} > faran$ (regular).

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes
West Germanic		Anglo Frisian Brightening
[no change]		OE A Restoration
Northwest Germanic		OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope
[no change]		OE Secondary Nasalization
		OE Weak Tail Reduction

Kroonen and Orel both treat **faran* as the inherited strong verb, and Campbell uses it as a standard example of A-restoration (Kroonen 2013, 149; Orel 2003, 132; Campbell 1959, 61). The Old English evidence is equally simple: dictionaries distinguish the strong infinitive *faran* from weak *færan*, while forms such as *fære* and *færð* belong to the present tense, not to the citation infinitive (Clark Hall 1960, 113; Bosworth and Toller 1898, 250). That is enough to explain why the regular comparison stays with *faran*. After Anglo-Frisian brightening, A-restoration before single *r* returns the stem vowel to *a*, and the later tail reductions yield the expected infinitive.

guest — OE *ġiest*

Derivation: **gástiz* > *ġiest* (regular).

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes
West Germanic		Anglo Frisian Brightening
[no change]		OE Velar Palatalization
Northwest Germanic		OE I Umlaut
PGmc Final Z Deletion	<i>*gásti</i>	OE Ws Palatal Diphthongization
		OE High Vowel Apocope

Campbell and Ringe and Taylor treat this as an ordinary i-stem whose West Saxon development produces *ġiest*, while non-West-Saxon evidence preserves forms of the *gest* type (Campbell 1959, 91; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 296). Bosworth-Toller and Clark Hall indeed record a family of spellings such as *gist*, *gest*, *ġiest*, and *gyst*, so the issue is not whether the West Saxon form exists, but which member of that attested set the book should foreground (Bosworth and Toller 1898, 387; Clark Hall 1960, 149). The derivation itself is regular: brightening and i-mutation reshape the stem, and West Saxon palatal diphthongization produces *ie*.

Dialect note. Anglian *gest* remains genuine Old English evidence, but it is a parallel dialectal comparator rather than a correction to West Saxon *ġiest* (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 296; Bosworth and Toller 1898, 387).

learn — OE *liornian*

Derivation: **līznōjaną* > *liornian* (regular).

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes
West Germanic		OE Breaking
[no change]		OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope
Northwest Germanic		OE Secondary Nasalization
[no change]		OE I Umlaut
		OE Unstressed Long Vowel Shortening
		OE Weak Tail Reduction
		OE Intervocalic J Vocalization
		OE Unstressed EI Contraction

Ringe and Taylor's class-II weak family and Kroonen's comparative base both support the same inherited verb, so the question here is not lexeme choice but dialectal targeting (Ringe and Taylor 2014, 318; Kroonen 2013, 328). Campbell's discussion is decisive for that point: Northumbrian *liornian* preserves *io*, whereas the more familiar *leornian* reflects a later *eo* development (Campbell 1959, 123; 1959, 296). The Old English evidence therefore does not force the dictionary headword. It allows the book to keep the Northumbrian form as the regular comparator for this branch.

Dialect note. The trace shows the regular phonological route from **līznōjanq* to *liornian*; the real interpretive burden is simply that most reference works privilege *leornian* instead (Clark Hall 1960, 193; Bright 1971, 58). In fuller treatment, the Northumbrian and West Saxon contrast may deserve a dedicated editorial comparison, but the essential point is already contained in the Northumbrian evidence itself.

linden — OE lind

Derivation: **līndō* > *lind* (regular).

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
West Germanic		OE High Vowel Apocope	<i>*līnd</i>
[no change]			
Northwest Germanic			
NWGmc Final Long O Raising	<i>*līndu</i>		

Kroonen's **līndō-* and the Old English dictionary evidence both point to the ordinary noun *lind* 'linden, lime-tree' (Kroonen 2013, 337; Clark Hall 1960, 198; Bosworth and Toller 1898, 630). The derivation is correspondingly brief: Northwest Germanic final *ō* raises to a **līndu* stage, and high-vowel apocope gives *lind*. No further explanation is needed beyond noting that Clark Hall's adjectival *linden* 'made of linden-wood' belongs to a different lexical use, not to the noun chosen here for direct comparison (Clark Hall 1960, 198).

mother — OE mōder

Derivation: **mōdēr* > *mōder* (regular).

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
West Germanic		OE Unstressed Long Vowel Shortening	<i>*mōdær</i>
[no change]		OE Unstressed AE Merger	<i>*mōder</i>
Northwest Germanic			
NWGmc Long E Lowering	<i>*mōdēr</i>		

The compact issue here is not whether the lexeme is right but which Old English form best represents the regular nominative line. Kroonen and Orel give the Proto-Germanic r-stem as **mōdēr-* or **mōdēr*, while Old English reference works more often print *mōdor* or *modor* and show oblique *mēder* elsewhere in the paradigm (Kroonen 2013, 368; Orel 2003, 274; Clark Hall 1960, 219; Campbell 1959, 598; Ringe and Taylor 2014, 312). The trace therefore supports a regular nominative *mōder*, not the later levelled dictionary headword. That is the point of compression in this entry: the philology lies in paradigm history, not in an irregular sound change.

Comparison note. The familiar *mōdor* should remain visible in fuller editorial treatment, because readers will expect it, but it does not replace the regular nominative reflex represented here.

show — OE scēawian

Derivation: **skāwōjanq* > *scēawian* (regular).

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
West Germanic		OE Aw Long Diphthong	*skéawōjaną
[no change]		OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope	*skéawōjan
Northwest Germanic		OE Secondary Nasalization	*skéawōjān
[no change]		OE Sk Palatalization	*jéawōjān
		OE I Umlaut	*jéawējān
		OE Unstressed Long Vowel Shortening	*jéawejan
		OE Weak Tail Reduction	*jéawejan
		OE Intervocalic J Vocalization	*jéaweian
		OE Unstressed EI Contraction	*jéawian

Orel and Kroonen both place the verb in the ordinary class-II show-family, and Brunner's Old English evidence *scēawian*, *scāwian* confirms that the entry is dealing with the standard lexeme rather than a special paradigm cell (Orel 2003, 339; Kroonen 2013, 482; Sievers 1965, 148). The regularity lies in the treatment of *aw* before a following vowel: the inherited form develops to Old English *ēaw*, while the class-II suffix preserves *ō* between *w* and *j*, yielding the expected *scēawian* (Campbell 1959, 138; Orel 2003, 339). The remaining wrinkle is orthographic, not philological.

Form note. The difference between dictionary *scēawian* and the book spelling *scēawian* is only normalization of initial (Campbell 1959, 19; Hogg 1992, 236).

weapon — OE wæpn

Derivation: *wépną > wæpn (regular).

Earlier Germanic changes		Old English changes	
West Germanic		OE Heavy Syllable Nasal Apocope	*wæpn
[no change]			
Northwest Germanic			
NWGmc Long E Lowering	*wæpną		

Kroonen's double-stem noun *wēbna- ~ wēpna- and Campbell's discussion of cluster nouns both show why this entry cannot be reduced to the familiar late West Saxon headword *wæpen* (Kroonen 2013, 617; Campbell 1959, 150; 1959, 226). Old English evidence preserves both broken and unbroken forms: Bright contrasts broken nominative *wæpen/wapen* with unbroken *wæpnes*, and Clark Hall likewise records the headword under *wapen* while preserving unbroken forms elsewhere (Bright 1971, 29; Clark Hall 1960, 355). The point of the book form *wæpn* is to represent the regular unbroken cluster word-finally, which the trace derives cleanly from *wépną.

Form note. The common simplex headword *wæpen* is real Old English, but it reflects later breaking in the simplex. The unbroken forms remain essential evidence for the regular line modeled here (Campbell 1959, 150; 1959, 226; Bright 1971, 29; Clark Hall 1960, 355).

References

- Bosworth, Joseph, and T. Northcote Toller. 1898. *An Anglo-Saxon Dictionary*. Clarendon Press.
- Bright, James W. 1971. *Bright's Old English Grammar and Reader*. 3rd edn. Edited by Frederic G. Cassidy and Richard N. Ringler. Holt, Rinehart; Winston.
- Campbell, Alistair. 1959. *Old English Grammar*. Clarendon Press.
- Clark Hall, J. R. 1960. *A Concise Anglo-Saxon Dictionary*. 4th edn. University of Toronto Press.
- Fulk, R. D. 2018. *A Comparative Grammar of the Early Germanic Languages*. Vol. 3. Studies in Germanic Linguistics. John Benjamins.
- Hogg, Richard M. 1992. *A Grammar of Old English. Volume 1: Phonology*. Blackwell.
- Kroonen, Guus. 2013. *Etymological Dictionary of Proto-Germanic*. Vol. 11. Leiden Indo-European Etymological Dictionary Series. Brill.
- Orel, Vladimir. 2003. *A Handbook of Germanic Etymology*. Brill.
- Ringe, Don, and Ann Taylor. 2014. *The Development of Old English*. Vol. 2. A Linguistic History of English. Oxford University Press.
- Sievers, Eduard. 1965. *Altenglische Grammatik*. 3rd edn. Edited by Karl Brunner. Niemeyer.